

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	
Team ID	
Project Name	Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Service Level Agreements (SLAs) are essential for ensuring that IT service requests and incidents are resolved within agreed timelines. In many organizations, SLA breaches occur because support teams are not notified proactively or fail to provide proper documentation explaining the reasons behind the delay. This leads to poor service quality, lack of accountability, compliance issues, and customer dissatisfaction.

The **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System** is designed to address these challenges by implementing an intelligent SLA governance solution using the ServiceNow platform. Instead of reacting after an SLA has already been breached, the system proactively identifies incidents approaching SLA violation, automatically notifies responsible users, enforces mandatory justification, and provides management with visibility into SLA performance through reports and dashboards.

Overall, the project transforms traditional SLA monitoring from a reactive manual process into a proactive, automated governance system. By combining workflow automation, conversational assistance, mandatory documentation, and analytical reporting, the solution enhances operational efficiency, improves compliance, increases transparency, and promotes

Step-1: Select the Problem Statement

In modern IT Service Management (ITSM), organizations rely on **Service Level Agreements (SLAs)** to ensure incidents and service requests are resolved within predefined timelines. However, many organizations face recurring SLA breaches due to delayed responses, lack of proactive monitoring, poor communication among support teams, and insufficient documentation explaining why service delays occurred. Most support engineers become aware of SLA violations only after they have already occurred, resulting in customer dissatisfaction, reduced service quality, audit concerns, and increased operational costs.

During our brainstorming session, we identified that manual monitoring of SLAs is inefficient and highly dependent on individuals remembering to track incident deadlines. Existing processes also lack accountability because engineers often update incidents without recording proper breach reasons or justifications. Managers have limited visibility into recurring SLA issues and spend considerable time preparing manual reports to understand service performance.

After discussing these operational challenges, our team selected the following problem statement:

"How can we design a proactive, intelligent, and zero-code ServiceNow solution that automatically detects SLA risk before breaches occur, alerts responsible users, enforces mandatory breach documentation, provides conversational guidance through Virtual Agent, and enables managers to monitor SLA performance through dashboards and reports?"

This problem was selected because it addresses a real-world challenge faced by IT support organizations and can significantly improve operational efficiency, compliance, transparency, and customer satisfaction.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

The team conducted a brainstorming session to identify multiple approaches for improving SLA governance. Several ideas were proposed and evaluated based on feasibility, automation capability, ease of implementation, maintainability, and business value.

Idea 1 – Manual SLA Monitoring

Support engineers manually monitor SLA timers and update incident records whenever they notice SLA deadlines approaching.

Limitations

- Time-consuming
- Human errors
- No proactive alerts
- Difficult to monitor large numbers of incidents

Idea 2 – Scheduled Email Notifications

Use scheduled jobs to send reminder emails at fixed intervals before SLA expiration.

Advantages

- Easy to implement
- Improves communication

Limitations

- Static reminders
- No intelligent decision-making
- No mandatory governance process

Idea 3 – Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Governance (Selected Idea)

Develop a fully automated SLA governance framework using native ServiceNow capabilities including:

- Flow Designer
- Virtual Agent
- UI Policies
- Email Notifications

- Reports
- Dashboards
- Incident Custom Fields

The proposed solution automatically detects when an incident reaches approximately **80% SLA utilization**, marks the incident as **SLA At Risk**, and triggers automated workflows.

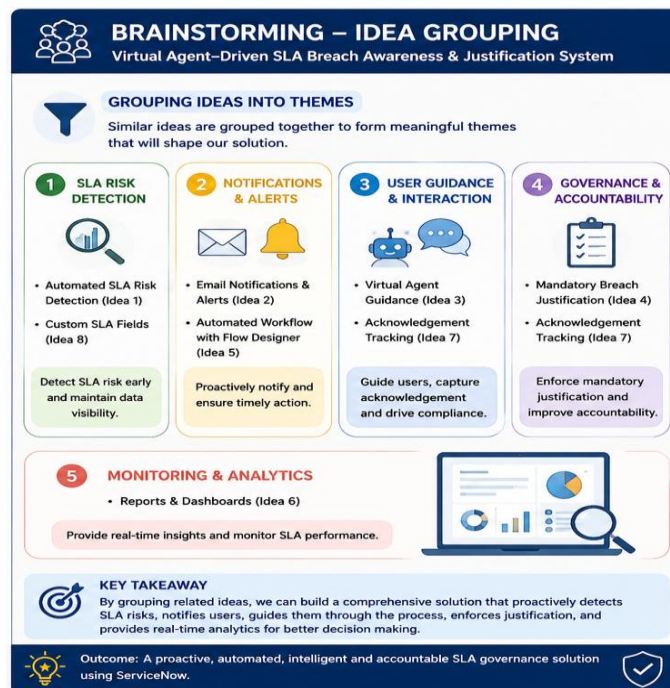
The system:

- Sends proactive email notifications to assigned support engineers.
- Makes **SLA Breach Reason** and **SLA Breach Justification** mandatory using UI Policies.
- Guides users through compliance using a conversational Virtual Agent.
- Captures SLA acknowledgements.
- Provides management with analytical dashboards and reports.
- Eliminates manual monitoring.
- Uses a **zero-code** implementation approach, making the solution easier to maintain and scale.

After comparing all ideas, the team concluded that this solution provides the highest business value while minimizing implementation complexity.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

The proposed ideas were prioritized using key evaluation criteria including innovation, feasibility, scalability, automation capability, maintainability, user experience, and organizational impact.



KEY TAKEAWAY

By grouping related ideas, we can build a comprehensive solution that proactively detects SLA risks, notifies users, guides them through the process, enforces justification, and provides real-time analytics for better decision making.



Outcome: A proactive, automated, intelligent and accountable SLA governance solution using ServiceNow.



Criteria	Manual Monitoring	Email Reminder	Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Governance
Automation	Low	Medium	Very High
Ease of Implementation	High	High	High
Maintenance	High	Medium	Low
User Experience	Low	Medium	Excellent
Accountability	Low	Medium	Very High
Reporting & Analytics	Low	Low	Excellent
Scalability	Low	Medium	Very High
Business Value	Medium	Medium	Excellent

Final Selected Idea

After evaluating all alternatives, the team selected **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System** because it provides a comprehensive, intelligent, and proactive approach to SLA governance.

The solution integrates multiple ServiceNow components into a unified workflow that automatically identifies SLA risks, notifies users, enforces mandatory documentation, guides engineers through Virtual Agent conversations, and provides management with real-time dashboards and reports.